



YOU ARE **26 WEEKS AND 1 DAY**

97 days to go

YOUR BABY TODAY

The coiling umbilical cord is very clearly seen in this image. The umbilical cord grows as your baby grows and will be about the same length as your baby at this stage of your pregnancy: about 14.4 in (36.6 cm).

“When you settle down for a nap it can be frustrating if your baby starts exercising, but take this as a sign that all is well.”

You may have noticed that your baby is more active at some times than at others, often when you're trying to relax or sleep! This is likely to be because when you're busy or distracted, you're less aware of your baby moving.

Babies have different cycle of waking and sleeping, and there are no rules as to when your baby should be kicking and when they should be still.

If you're familiar with your baby's pattern of movements and are concerned that you haven't felt them move, or the pattern of movements has changed, you should let your doctor know and do fetal kick counts. Have a snack and glass of water, and lay down on your side with your hands on your stomach. Try to relax and focus on your baby's movements.

If you are not able to notice your baby's movements, then you will need to be evaluated at your doctor's office or at the hospital. When you go to the hospital, they will monitor your baby's heart rate by performing a nonstress test. They may offer an ultrasound to demonstrate fetal movement to you so you can feel more reassured when you go home.

Remember that while most of the time not feeling your baby move well is a false alarm, you don't want to ignore this as it can be the only sign that something catastrophic has happened.

ASK A DOCTOR

Why am I being told I need to have a glucose tolerance test? In pregnancy, some women develop a form of diabetes known as [gestational diabetes](#), which disappears when the baby is born.

Certain women are more likely to develop gestational diabetes, including

- those with a family history of it
- those who have had a previous pregnancy with gestational diabetes
- those with a high BMI